

TRUSTMRR DATASET

# Anatomy of 1,000 Indie & Micro-SaaS Startups

*A data-driven look at revenue, markets, geography, and the economics of building small software companies in 2026.*

Personal research brief · Data frozen 30 Jul 2026 · n = 1,000 startups

# What's in this dataset — and its limits

**1,000**

startups tracked

Live revenue pulled directly from founders' payment APIs (Stripe, RevenueCat, etc.), not self-reported.

**29**

data fields

Revenue (30d/3m/12m/all-time), MRR & growth, subscribers, traffic, category/market tags, and resale asking price.

**~30%**

fields with gaps

129 rows are anonymized 'Stealth Company' listings with no name, site, or category — expect blanks throughout.

*Read every stat in this deck against that backdrop: this is a snapshot of indie-hacker and micro-SaaS businesses, skewed toward the smallest and most active listings — not venture-scale companies.*

# Five things that stood out

1

## Revenue is a power law

Median MRR is just \$282, but the mean is \$13,472 — 48x higher. One company (Stan) holds 26% of all MRR in the dataset.

3

## SaaS and AI lead every market cut

By total MRR, SaaS (\$4.4M) and AI (\$3.4M) markets dominate — AI alone tags 39% of all categorized startups.

5

## Stripe is the default rail

66% of startups run on Stripe; RevenueCat (20%) is a distant second, reflecting the mobile-app subset.

2

## 1 in 5 startups earns nothing

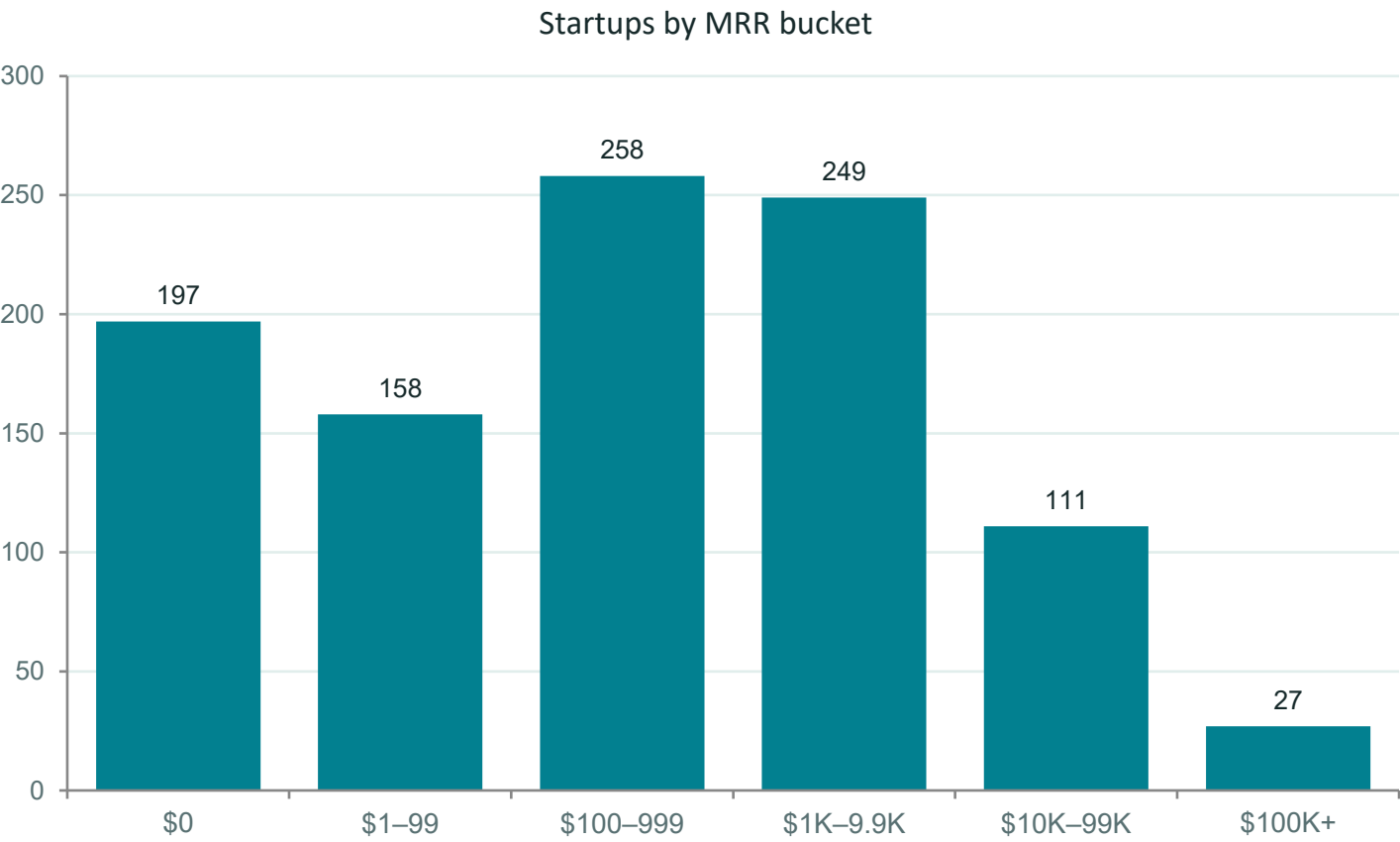
197 of 1,000 startups report exactly \$0 current MRR despite having historical revenue — likely dead, paused, or pre-relaunch.

4

## Consumer beats business, 56/36

B2C outnumbers B2B startups on this platform — consistent with a solo-founder, product-led building wave.

# MRR is heavily right-skewed



\$282

Median MRR

\$13.5K

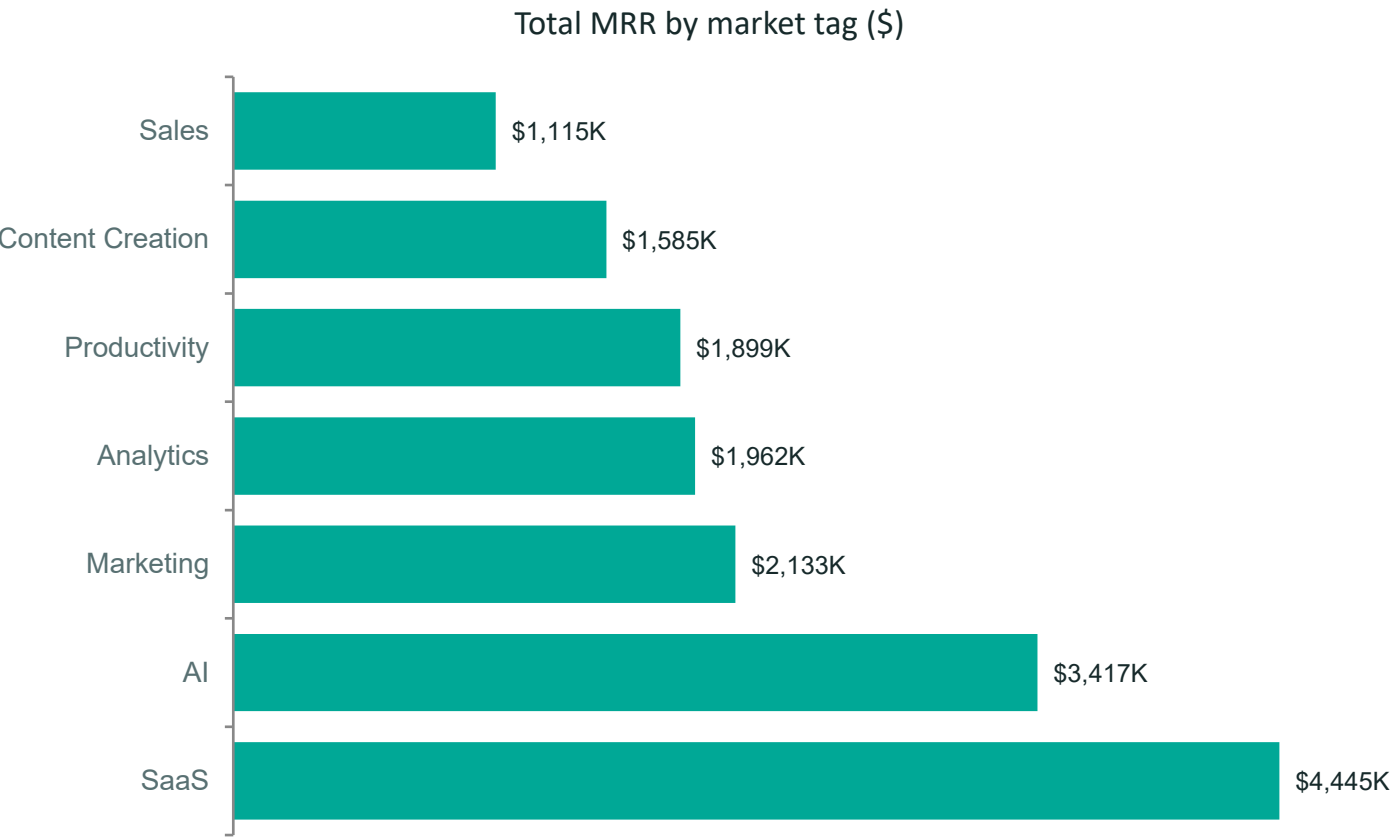
Mean MRR

26%

Share of all MRR held by the #1 startup (Stan)

Takeaway: a handful of breakout companies carry most of the dollar volume. The typical listed startup is a small, low-revenue side project.

# SaaS and AI lead every market by MRR



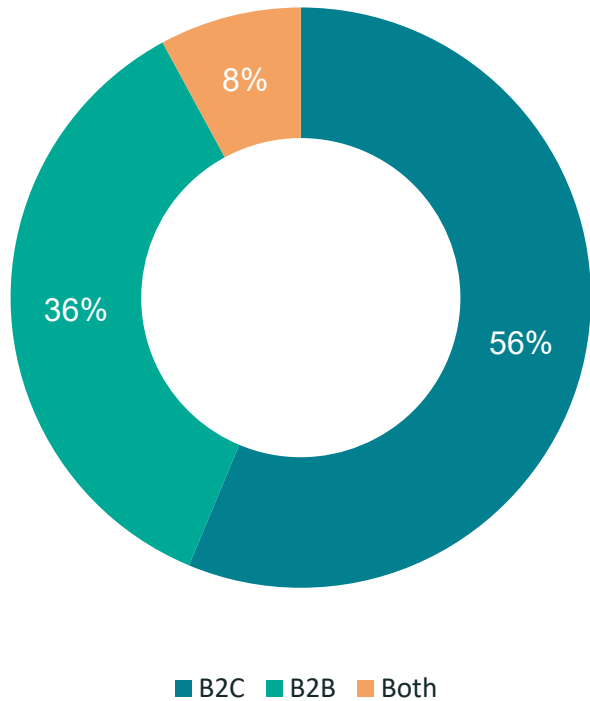
Market pivot: count & typical size

| Market       | # Startups | Median MRR |
|--------------|------------|------------|
| SaaS         | 437        | \$438      |
| AI           | 392        | \$431      |
| Marketing    | 159        | \$1,357    |
| Analytics    | 131        | \$910      |
| Productivity | 275        | \$197      |
| Sales        | 42         | \$2,153    |

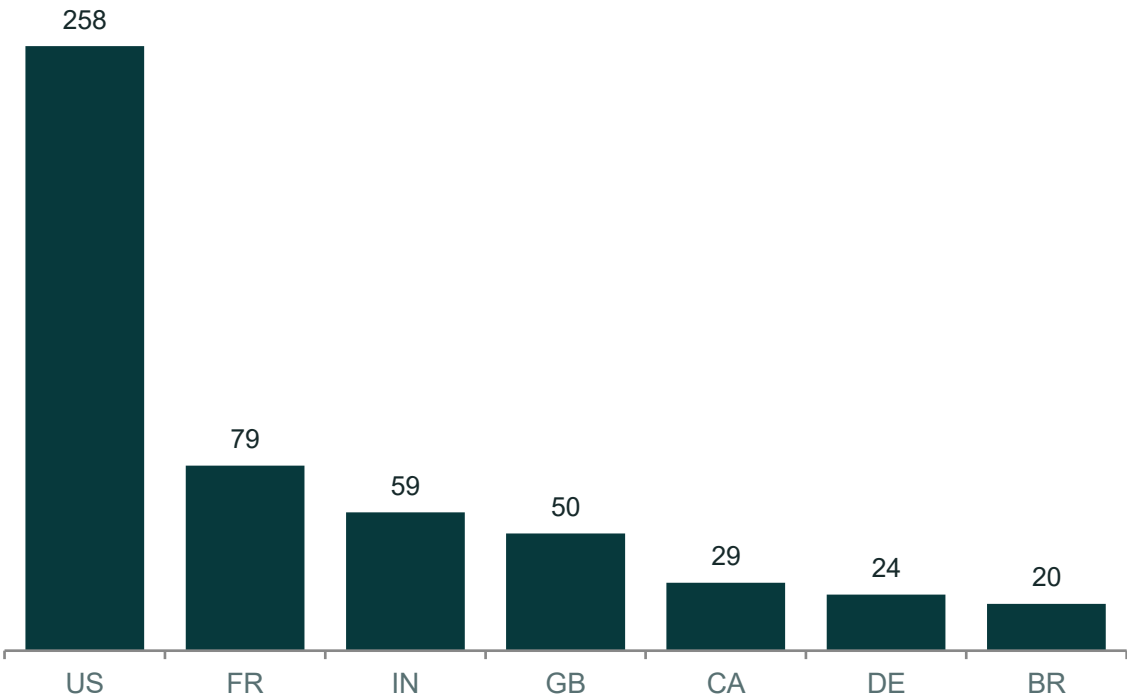
*Note: markets are multi-label (one startup can carry several tags), so a startup's MRR counts toward every market it's tagged with.*

# Consumer-first, US-anchored, global tail

Audience type (% of labeled)

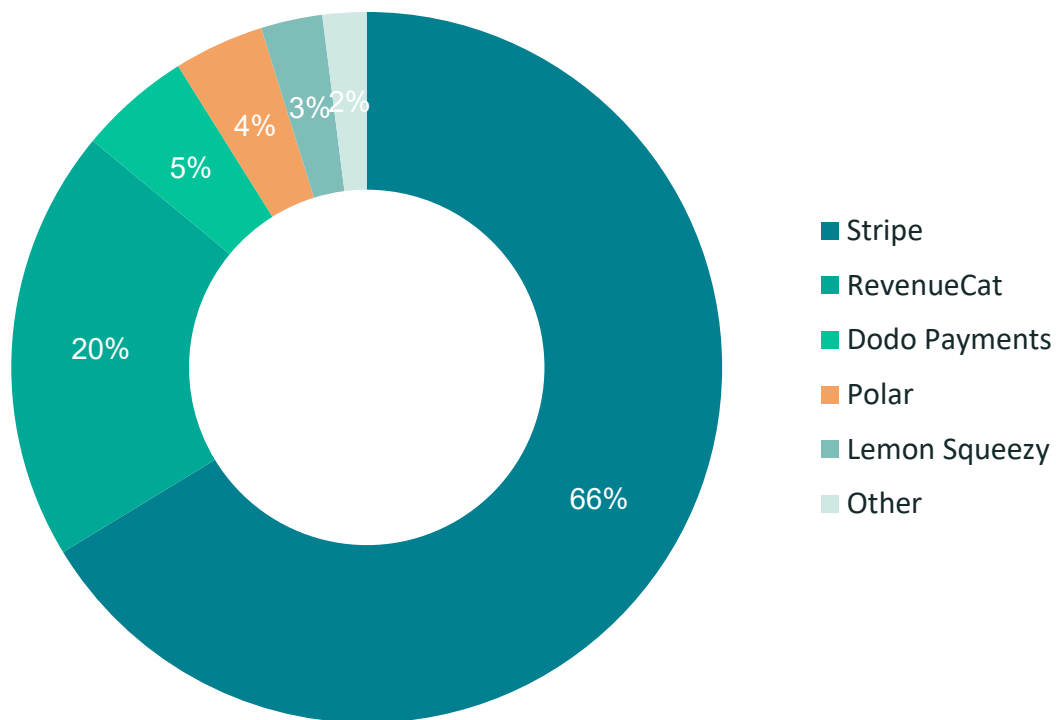


Top countries by startup count



241 of 1,000 rows have no country listed. Among those with one, the US leads decisively — but France, India, and the UK show meaningful indie-founder activity.

# Stripe is the default rail for indie founders



## What the stack tells us

- Stripe (66%) is the default for web-based SaaS and e-commerce billing — the platform's core audience.
- RevenueCat (20%) manages in-app purchase billing — this maps closely to the Mobile Apps category (52 startups).
- The long tail (Dodo, Polar, Lemon Squeezy, Whop, Creem) reflects newer, indie-friendly Merchant-of-Record tools gaining share from Stripe.

## 262 startups are listed for sale

**262**

of 1,000 startups  
(26%) are on sale

**\$35,000**

median asking price

**\$1,055**

median MRR of  
for-sale startups

**2.3x**

median revenue  
multiple asked

### Reading the multiple

A 2.3x revenue multiple means a typical buyer is pricing these micro-SaaS businesses at roughly 2-3x their annual revenue — well below the 4-8x+ multiples seen for larger, more established SaaS companies. This is consistent with a market of small, high-churn-risk, single-founder-dependent businesses, where buyers price in the risk that revenue doesn't survive an ownership transition.



# What this dataset really shows

- 1 This is a snapshot of the indie/micro-SaaS economy, not venture-scale startups — median MRR of \$282 says it plainly.
- 2 AI and SaaS aren't just popular labels — they carry the most aggregate revenue too, suggesting real monetization, not just hype tagging.
- 3 The resale market (26% of listings) prices these businesses cautiously — around 2x revenue — reflecting key-person and durability risk.
- 4 Stripe's dominance (66%) and RevenueCat's mobile niche (20%) map cleanly onto where these founders actually sell: web SaaS vs. mobile apps.